

Keeping you in the loop on status, the modeling tension, and **what I’m going with** for the core manuscript (Summer–Fall 2026). Detail: 20260611_Brief_for_Alex_Gates_full.md.

Status: LOO peer-pool quality inverted-U replicated (Army  · basketball  · tenure $\triangle$ preliminary). Bottleneck is **one coherent minimal-model story** + draft — not finding the curve.

Model tension (context)

Track	Axis	Result today
Empirical	LOO pool quality	Inverted-U — cross-domain stylized fact
Generative	Alex score on pool mean	Inverted-U POC; same knobs on LOO axis → mostly decreasing
Decomposition	$L_{\text{net}} = B - D$	One object intended; needs explicit nesting in prose

LOO = peers excluding self · *pool mean* = whole roster including self

What I’m going with

Area	My call
Timeline	Core manuscript draft/submission Summer–Fall 2026
Generative path	Manuscript-first: draft on empirical LOO U + honest generative POC (pool-mean readout) + explicit axis table; not blocking on generative LOO-pool-quality match before first draft
Mechanism prose	Alex score = constraint-leg POC; empirical decomposition for predictions — one $L = B - D$ story in writing (SCOUT to supply nesting chain for VECTOR §3)
Tenure (Setting 3)	Stage 9 + limitations → start prose now; Cell 12 Cox not urgent during draft — basic run before submission ; Fine–Gray deferred
Deferred	Army 525/TB-stratify · network extensions · full HPC sweeps · LOO generative bin-for-bin match

Scientific north star (longer run): unified decomposable generative model that reads out on LOO pool quality — parallel work if time allows; does not gate the first draft.

If you see a problem with this sequencing, I’m happy to adjust.